MAHARASHTRA

SHINDE'S REVERSAL RAJ

By Kiran D. Tare

Chief minister Eknath Shinde seems to be on a mission to erase any stamp his predecessor and one-time boss Uddhav Thackeray had left on the administration. So far, he has reversed six major policy decisions

METRO-3 CAR SHED

Thackeray: Shifted the metro car shed to Kanjurmarg from Aarey Milk Colony, a site that had evoked a lot of protest over green concerns
Result: Project got stuck as Kanjurmarg land is under litigation; cost increase: Rs 10,000 crore
Shinde: Brought car shed back to Aarey saying the Supreme Court has cleared project site
Status: Project has taken off again. Trial run conducted on Aug. 30 for underground metro line
Impact: Green activists relaunch agitation. SEEPZ-Bandra leg may be complete by June '23

BULLET TRAIN TERMINUS

Thackeray: Denied land to the National High Speed Railway Corporation Ltd (NHSRCL) to construct terminus at Bandra-Kurla Complex
Result: Project delayed by two years; cost overruns: Rs 12,000 crore
Shinde: Orders removal of a Covid care centre set up on demarcated land, hands it over to NHSRCL
Status: Work on removing Covid care centre is on. Tender for construction of the bullet train terminus has been floated
Impact: Maharashtra lags behind in land acquisition for the project, so this move could expedite the process

'EMERGENCY WARRIORS' PENSION

Thackeray: Stopped monthly pension of Rs 10,000 to those jailed during Emergency (1975-77)
Result: Around 4,500 people affected
Shinde: Restarted the pension scheme
Status: At present, 3,600 people are entitled to the pension. Applications of another 800 people under consideration
Impact: Most beneficiaries are RSS

ANI





ANI

TELANGANA

UNDUE HASTE

By Amarnath K. Menon

Tragedies caused by appalling neglect regularly visit the state-run healthcare system in India. Consider the deaths of 63 children in Gorakhpur's BRD Medical College and Hospital in 2017 due to a lack of oxygen cylinders, or the death of 15 women in Chhattisgarh in a sterilisation campaign in 2014. In a similar instance, botched sterilisation procedures at a state-run Community Health Centre (CHC) at Ibrahimpatnam, on the outskirts of Hyderabad, on August 25 has led to the deaths of four young women. Wary of the inevitable public furore, the Telangana government rushed in to make amends: a cash grant of Rs 5 lakh and a 2BHK apartment was announced for the families of each of the deceased. A probe was also ordered into the incident, headed by Dr G. Srinivasa Rao, the director of Public Health Services.

Due diligence was allegedly wanting at the CHC, where 34 women had undergone double puncture laparoscopy (DPL) that day. The surgeries were alleged to have been done hurriedly, by a single doctor, under insanitary conditions—everything was sewn up in a couple of hours, when the prescribed procedure for each patient, including pre-surgery preparation, needs at least 45 minutes. Some of the women have even alleged that regular diagnostic tests, meant to take account of their medical history, were not done, as is the practice.

The DPL procedure is a preferred method of sterilisation as per Union health ministry guidelines, but not few surgeons doing many surgeries at large camps. The Ibrahimpatnam deaths have brought into focus the prevailing practice in Telangana: while the prescribed number of such surgeries is 30 a day, the four government surgeons in the state trained to perform DPLs do many, many more. The average daily DPL procedures each of the four does is a whopping 48. Since April 2022, Telangana has held 111 sterilisation camps at which an astounding 38,656



THE PRESCRIBED NUMBER OF DPL SURGERIES ARE 30 A DAY. THE FOUR SURGEONS DO AS MANY AS 48 EACH